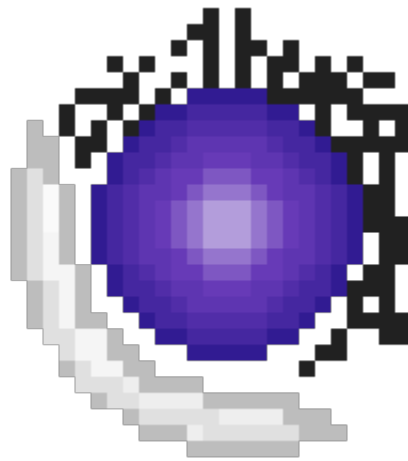


THE CREATION

THE BALLAD OF AETHEIOPEIA



ETIQUETTE

AETHEIOPEIA: “THE STRONGEST TO
REIGN.”

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I

PRELUDE

"THE TIME HAS COME!"

"Today, my friends, Aetheiopeia has destroyed our enemy! Our horizons shall expand as we dominate the rest of our universe, and then perhaps the Multiverse as well! For the Aetheiopeians are no more!"

The hall stood to applaud their king, who, despite his evil and dark intentions, had succeeded in his conquest and carried his people through the hardship that came with this conquest.

The vain king of Aetheiopeia, the third kingdom of the fifth of many worlds in the Elzeinien multiverse, Dunére had commissioned a war with the other kingdoms. In the three years that followed, the other three kingdoms, Darceu, Everbliss, and most importantly, the head kingdom of Dunére, Aetheiopeia, were vanquished (along with many soldiers on the Aetheiopeian side but should that be talked about within vicinity of the Aetheiopeian law enforcement, the offender would be killed). As inferred in the above brackets, the king had quite the ego, and so few would challenge him upon any matter.

But things are never consistent, are they?

And so, a woman stood.

"But what about the deceased soldiers?" She shouted. "My son died in the war! When will there be a funeral for our lost?!"

To this the king smiled cruelly. "Come with me."

And to no one's surprise, there was a warrant for the woman's execution the very next day, and there came with it a notice for the public execution that very day in Loyalty Square, or as most people called it, Blood Square. There should be no need to explain the meaning of that.

And as the execution began, the king stood and announced:

"There should be no room for weakness in our world! If we are to survive for long, we need not sit around and denounce our leadership and our council, for they, and I, your King Arcanus, will lead you through all hardship, if you would give us respect. And now... ..BEGIN!"

In this last word there was no mercy, no compassion. But this next sentence would best describe the King Arcanus's true nature.

"OFF WITH HER HEAD!"

But then the crowd cheered. They had truly been brainwashed by their king. For now, we shall leave the crowd and their heartless king to be, for, though the war was over, there would be more troubles for Aetheiopeia. For in the embers of the smoking Capital of Dunére, also known as Celkiyae, there were survivors. *Angry survivors.*

II

THE EMBERS OF WAR

CELKIYAE, THE ONCE GREAT CAPITAL OF DUNÉRE.

Alas, for now it is nothing but craters and ruin. The reign of King Arcanus was no laughing matter, and it would not be for another twenty-five years.

But through the dust and the few lasting embers, there were survivors. Sparse, spread out throughout the ruins of not only Celkiyae but also the other demolished cities of Dunére. They would eventually band together against the new King. For now, we visit the dark Imperial Unit in the centre of Celkiyae's massive underground military network.

The tunnels were dark. Once made almost impenetrable by the sophisticated security systems and superior material technology used in their construction, they were now but the empty shells that once held one of the most advanced armies of all of Elzeinia. Their significance however, remained. These dark tunnels were the last to fall, the last obstacle in the direct line to the throne.

A lone figure stands in the gloom. In his hand is a glowing Khopesh enchanted with the hardest to find books, able to chop any beast to shreds with one swing. This was the blade Bloodhunter.



AETHEIOPEIAN TERMS AND PHRASES

Multiverse Concept- The concept regarding universes, alternate realities, and imagination. It states that universes are all part of a larger multiverse, categorizing the laws and inner workings of the universes. Every alternate reality is not only possible but in existence. Imagination is simply a subconscious visit to another universe.

Elzeinia- The universe in which Dunére exists, containing universes with RPG elements.

Khopesh – An Egyptian sword, sickle-shaped and a product of battle axes. Here a weapon invented by Aetheiopeians.

Essenc- Old Aetheiopeian spelling for essence.

Blood Essenc- An essence built of blood and a manifestation of death magic.

Darkstone- A black stone with great magical properties. Used primarily in rituals.

Dunére Speed Stat System- Speed is counted in seconds and in the case of weapon stats dictates the time it takes for a weapon to cooldown.

Dunére Damage System- The average person has a health bar of one hundred health points- each damage point in the item profile of the weapon deals exactly one health point.

Dunére Enchantment System- Enchantments are magical improvements you can add to items. Each enchantment starts at level 1(I) and each level after that adds perks or improves the quality of previous perks added. They are typically stored in books and can also be extracted directly from respective levels of magic sources.

Defiance- A rare enchantment that deflects the effects of the enchantments of the opponent's weapon back onto the opponent.